

Domain 4: Billing, Pricing, and Support – Complete Topic List

1. Pricing Models

- **On-Demand Instances:** Pay-as-you-go model without any long-term commitment.
- **Reserved Instances:** Commit to a one- or three-year term for significant savings.
- **Spot Instances:** Purchase unused capacity at reduced rates, ideal for flexible, interruption-tolerant tasks.
- **Savings Plans:** Flexible pricing model offering savings over On-Demand rates in exchange for a commitment to a consistent amount of usage.
- **Dedicated Hosts:** Physical servers dedicated to your use, useful for compliance requirements.
- **Capacity Reservations:** Reserve capacity for your Amazon EC2 instances to ensure availability when you need it.

2. Cost and Usage Tools

- **AWS Pricing Calculator:** Estimate the cost of AWS services before deployment.
- **AWS Cost Explorer:** Visualize and analyze your AWS spending patterns.
- **AWS Budgets:** Set custom cost and usage budgets that alert you when you exceed them.
- **AWS Cost and Usage Report:** Detailed CSV reports of your AWS usage and costs.
- **AWS Cost Anomaly Detection:** Identify unusual spending patterns using machine learning.
- **AWS Cost Categories:** Organize your AWS costs into meaningful categories for better tracking.

3. Billing and Account Management

- **AWS Billing Dashboard:** Central place to manage your AWS billing and payment methods.
- **Consolidated Billing:** Combine multiple AWS accounts to receive a single bill and potentially lower rates.
- **Linked Accounts:** Manage multiple AWS accounts under a single payer account.
- **Payment Methods:** Add and manage credit cards, debit cards, and other payment methods.
- **Invoices:** Access and download invoices for your AWS usage.

4. Support Plans

- **Basic Support:** Free support plan that includes 24/7 access to customer service, documentation, whitepapers, and AWS Trusted Advisor checks.
- **Developer Support:** Includes all Basic support features plus business hours email access to Cloud Support Associates.
- **Business Support:** Includes all Developer support features plus 24/7 access to Cloud Support Engineers via email, chat, and phone.

- **Enterprise Support:** Includes all Business support features plus a Technical Account Manager (TAM), Concierge Support Team, and access to AWS Infrastructure Event Management.

5. Cost Optimization

- **Right-Sizing:** Choose the appropriate instance types and sizes for your workloads.
- **Auto Scaling:** Automatically adjust the number of EC2 instances to meet demand.
- **Elastic Load Balancing:** Distribute incoming application traffic across multiple targets.
- **Spot Instances:** Utilize Spot Instances for flexible, interruption-tolerant tasks.
- **Reserved Instances:** Commit to a one- or three-year term for significant savings.
- **Savings Plans:** Flexible pricing model offering savings over On-Demand rates in exchange for a commitment to a consistent amount of usage.

6. Cost Allocation and Reporting

- **Cost Allocation Tags:** Assign tags to your AWS resources to track costs.
- **AWS Cost and Usage Report:** Detailed CSV reports of your AWS usage and costs.
- **AWS Cost Explorer:** Visualize and analyze your AWS spending patterns.
- **AWS Budgets:** Set custom cost and usage budgets that alert you when you exceed them.
- **AWS Cost Categories:** Organize your AWS costs into meaningful categories for better tracking.

7. AWS Marketplace Billing

- **Third-Party Software:** Purchase and manage third-party software through the AWS Marketplace.
- **Bring Your Own License (BYOL):** Use your existing software licenses with AWS services.
- **Software Subscriptions:** Subscribe to software products and manage billing through AWS.

Domain 4: Billing, Pricing, and Support – Complete Topic List

1. AWS Pricing Models

- **On-Demand** – pay for what you use, no upfront cost
- **Reserved Instances** – commit to 1 or 3 years, get discount
- **Savings Plans** – flexible discount for compute usage

- **Spot Instances** – bid for unused capacity, lower cost
 - **Dedicated Hosts** – physical servers for compliance needs
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2. Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) & Cost Estimation

- **TCO Calculator** – estimate cost savings vs on-premises
 - **AWS Pricing Calculator** – plan and estimate costs before deployment
 - **Cost Comparison** – on-premises vs cloud
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3. Billing & Cost Management Tools

- **AWS Cost Explorer** – visualize and analyze cost trends
 - **AWS Budgets** – set alerts for cost or usage thresholds
 - **AWS Billing Dashboard** – track your bills and payment methods
 - **AWS Cost and Usage Report** – detailed billing report
 - **Consolidated Billing (Organizations)** – combine multiple accounts for centralized billing
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4. Support Plans

- **Basic** – free, includes billing & account support
 - **Developer** – business hours email support
 - **Business** – 24/7 support via phone, chat, email + Trusted Advisor
 - **Enterprise** – 24/7 with technical account manager, Concierge Support
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5. Cost Optimization Strategies

- **Right-sizing resources** – choose proper instance types and sizes
 - **Turn off unused resources** – stop idle EC2 instances, unattached EBS
 - **Use spot/reserved instances** – reduce compute cost
 - **Monitor with Trusted Advisor** – cost optimization, performance, security checks
 - **Use Savings Plans effectively** – predictable workloads
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6. Billing Concepts

- **Pay-as-you-go** – flexible, based on actual usage
- **CapEx vs OpEx** – cloud reduces upfront costs, shifts to operational expenses
- **Free Tier** – AWS free usage limits for learning/testing
- **Tagging for cost allocation** – organize resources by project, department

7. AWS Marketplace Billing

- **Third-party software** – pay via AWS billing
- **Bring-your-own-license (BYOL)** – manage software license costs

☒ That's **everything in Domain 4**. No topic left out.